

Bellapais Abbey & St. Hilarion

Mountain Views Route

ROUTE DISTANCE: APPROX. 20 KM | DURATION: 4-5 HOURS (6 STOPS)

Your Stops

1. Bellapais Village

Begin in the village before rushing to the monument. The small streets, stone houses and calm pace help set the mood.

2. Bellapais Abbey

The abbey sits on a natural terrace in the Five Finger Mountains, giving the stop both history and a strong view toward the coast.

3. Bellapais Viewpoint Cafés

Pause near the village viewpoint area for a drink or snack. This makes the route feel less rushed and offers great vistas.

4. St. Hilarion Castle Lower Area

Arrive at the castle and begin with the lower sections. The ruins already feel dramatic right from the first levels.

5. St. Hilarion Upper Viewpoint

The climb becomes the reward. From the higher points, the route turns into a sweeping panoramic view experience over Kyrenia.

6. Kyrenia Mountain Road Photo Stop

Finish with a safe roadside viewpoint on the way back. It gives the route a clean ending and another chance for landscape photos.

Local Insider Tip

Do Bellapais first, then St. Hilarion. The village is more relaxed earlier in the day, and the castle views become better when the light softens.

Checklist

- Wear shoes with grip because castle steps can be uneven.
- Bring water, especially in summer.
- Driving is recommended between Bellapais and St. Hilarion.
- Check opening times before going, especially outside peak season.